The Pillowfight

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BDT 2017 · Mallorca · Featuring Adam T, Buzz & BT

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

One of the all-time great moments on tour came on BDT 2017, being the climax to a crucial Singles match between Big Buzz and Adam T, that has subsequently become known as "The Pillowfight".

Played on the 18th hole at Son Gual golf course, not only was this possibly the poorest hole of golf ever played on tour, but it was also critical in terms of both the battle for the Shitzu between the two Dogs in question and, even more importantly, the destiny of the 2017 Big Dogs Tour trophy, as it effectively became the deciding hole for the Ryder Cup contest that year.



Big Dogs Ryder Cup – Mallorca 2017
Day III – Son Gual

Bloodhounds			Retrievers	
Won 5&4	Little	v	BT	
	Buzz (c)	v	Adam T	Won 1UP
Won 2&1	Hulmey	v	Marshy (c)	
	Boysie	v	Tully	Won 1UP
Won 2UP	Langers	v	Hursty	
	Ash	v	Knoxy	Won 3&2
	Ravo	v	Gav	Won 2&1
Won 4&3	Adam G	v	Paddy MDE	
Day III Score	4		4	Day III Score
Overall Score	7½		8½	Overall Score

Singles Results



Buzz is delighted to receive the Shitzu!

I can do no better than to let Adam tell you the story in his own words:



ADAM T

"The day started off the same as any other I've had on tour, with an iron fisted mental focus to avoid being the Shitzu at all costs. I've had some close calls in my previous tours but have thus far been able to avoid this particular 'honour' by the skin of my teeth. Having said that, I think I was Shitzu on day 2 of that year for the first time but that further made me determined to avoid the overall tour award.

My main 'challenger' for the Shitzu was the Big Man and it just so happened that we'd been drawn together in the Singles and not only that, we were also shooting off first. My playing partner for the Retrievers was BT, so I felt I was in great hands. BT was running away with the Singles title and I knew he'd have his work cut out to caddy me round to a victory, but I also couldn't think of anyone better for the job in the circumstances.

Conversely, Ciaran was partnering Big Green, which made me feel even better, as Ciaran isn't, how can I put it, 'encouraging' and was definitely going to be a negative for the Big Man.

The first nine holes were pretty uneventful. I think Big Green was 1 up. Then disaster struck. BT must have been watching Colin McRae earlier that day, as after teeing off he tried to do a rally turn in our buggy and proceeded to crash into the tee kerb trapping his hand in the steering wheel. He appeared in considerable pain and, selfishly, all I could think about was that my safety blanket was compromised.

Fast forward to the 18th tee. Somehow, we were all square. I'd managed to drain a miraculous 20-foot downhill snake of a putt on the 15th or 16th to keep me in contention and here we were on the 18th for all the marbles. The hole was daunting with a brook going up the left-hand side of the fairway, then going across a few hundred yards up to then hugging the right-hand side of the fairway all the way to the green. Basically, water danger on every shot. Not ideal.

By this point BT was a broken man. Injured hand in ice and a bucket load of Stella Miguels down, I knew I was on my own. To be honest I thought BT was being a bit of a p***y, as it was only a sprained wrist. Later turned out to be a broken hand so "my bad" BT.







The 18th at Son Gual and BT's Broken Hand!

With some water hugging shots, both Big Green and I managed to make it safely to the edge of the green having taken the same number of shots. It would come down to the short game for not only the Shitzu but also the match and (although we didn't know it at the time) the whole Ryder Cup.

Big Green was on the edge of the green, which meant he could putt it whereas I was a little further away and had to chip.

"Just hit the centre of the green and put the pressure on'" was all I was thinking. Tension was high as I swung and managed to put it on the green, albeit 25 feet away, but I thought "I'll take that"; however, it was very much advantage the Big Man. Silence descended as Green rifled his putt all the way through the green to the fringe on the other side. At one point I thought it was going into the water but that infamy fortunately was spared for him.

There was silence for what seemed like an eternity as no one wanted to be first to show any emotion. Eventually Ciaran just simply put his head in his hands to which BT and I just erupted. Big Green trudged solemnly to the other side of the green as it was still his honour! Predictably he overcompensated and just tiddled his putt on the green leaving it a good 20 foot short. Momentum had swung back in my direction. Unfortunately, I didn't seize the moment as I raced my putt about 15 feet by! Nerves were definitely starting to take hold and this wasn't one for the purists!



The Shitzu

We were back level but this time I held a slight advantage. Big Green was next up with his effort. It didn't go anywhere near the hole with the Big Man leaving it probably 10 feet away. I was just thinking to myself "just 2 putt from here and put the pressure on Green" as, if the previous 5 minutes were anything to go by, that would be enough. I managed to putt my next shot to within about 4 feet and then sink the subsequent putt to leave Green with a 10-footer to halve not only the match, but, more importantly, to avoid the Shitzu.

Inevitably the putt was missed, and the match was lost with Big Green having somehow managed to 5-putt from the edge of the green. Cue the customary "a half would have been a fair result", "forget about it Big Man", "happens to the best of us" chat, whereas deep down inside we all knew we'd witnessed the most atrocious ending to a Singles match ever on BDT from both myself and Green and one that decided the fate of the Ryder Cup, with the Retrievers emerging victorious courtesy of my vital extra half point. The Shitzu was avoided for another year but it is getting perilously close! ”